

THE CONTENTS, PAGINATED

MEDIAN, as an illustrated book

The GDD v0.4.6 section tree, with every INFOGRAPHIC, ARTWORK, CREATED VISUAL and NARRATIVE PANEL set at the point in the text where it belongs — and a page figure against each. Part totals at the foot of every Part; a book total at the end.

266.5

PAGES, ALL IN

10

PLATES IN THIS SET

15

NARRATIVE PANELS

24,140

WORDS OF SET TEXT MEASURED

WHAT IS NEW HERE

The panels are not a new content class.

A Tale Panel is the Records printed — literary view left, the Almanac’s half of the same event right. §22.2 already requires this prose as the mandatory fallback behind every CREATED VISUAL.

Fifteen panels, five per colony.

New Elderbank, Morningside and Rushbottom, each carrying the mechanics its species makes hardest to fake. Eleven are THE TALE; four are THE CHRONICLE.

Every page figure is measured, not guessed.

Derived from actual word counts, plus a surcharge for tables, pull-quotes and OPEN blocks. The method is set out on the final plate.

THE FIVE MARKS

■	INFOGRAPHIC	1–2 p
	<i>An information-design plate.</i>	
◆	ARTWORK	1–2 p
	<i>Full-page image.</i>	
■	NARRATIVE PANEL	1 p
	<i>A Tale or Chronicle page: prose left, mechanic card right.</i>	
◆	CREATED VISUAL	0.5 p
	<i>A named in-fiction moment, inline, carrying its fallback.</i>	
◆	WORKED EXAMPLE	0.5–6 p
	<i>An example of play.</i>	

Spot illustrations are not listed. They attach to body-text pages throughout and are already priced into the words-per-page figure.

WHAT A 0.5 MEANS

That the section shares a page with its neighbour — not that it is given a half-page of its own. Bare parent headings carry no allocation at all.

THE CENSUS

CLASS	COUNT	PAGES
Set text	133 sections	123.5
Infographics	43	48
Full-page artwork	25 items	33
Narrative panels	15	15
Created visuals	8	4
Worked examples	6	18.5
Front, appendices, back	—	24.5

TOTAL 266.5

PANELS BY COLONY

New Elderbank · rabbit · Tribute	5
Morningside · squirrel · Aspirational	5
Rushbottom · wood mouse · Grounded	5

PANELS BY KICKER

THE TALE · citizen scale, possessive	11
THE CHRONICLE · colony scale	4

NOTES ON THE SHAPE

Part IV is 49.5 pages, and that is correct.

Part IV is the citizens — six of the fifteen panels, five full-page artworks, ten infographics, and the two longest sections in the document. The book’s claim is that the player will know these animals by name. Part IV is where the claim is made, and it should be the heaviest part of the book.

Part VI is 8 pages, and that is a flag.

The Metropolis has a Part to itself on the grounds that it is unlike anything else in the world — and it carries less text than §21.1 Active Guests alone. Either it earns more material, or it folds into Part V and the book has eight Parts.

Part VIII takes no opener and no plates.

It is explicitly not canon, and the canonical summary has moved forward to the front matter. Four pages, and it should stay austere.

FRONT MATTER

Before Part I. The book states its claim, then hands the reader the catastrophe.

◆ Title and Wordmark — cracked-asphalt letterfill, the “/” logomark	1 p
● Half-title, credits, colophon note	1 p
● Contents	2 p
● Sidebar — On the art markers, and the four content classes	0.5 p
● Sidebar — The optional generative layer, and why nothing depends on it	0.5 p
● Elevator pitch	1 p
● One-paragraph canonical summary (§38, moved forward)	1.5 p
● The Founding Escape	2.5 p
■ The Founding Escape and Onboarding	1 p
■ PANEL 1 · THE CHRONICLE — “What the cut reached”	1 p
Rushbottom · Barley, Thimble, Pip	

FRONT MATTER — 12 PAGES

PART I — WHAT MEDIAN IS

Thesis and pillars, then the shape of the game: four registers, three species, two loops, one folklore.

◆ Opener — The Colony Between Two Highways	1 p
● Part standfirst	0.5 p
● 1. Creative thesis	0.5 p
— 1.1 Core inspirations	1 p
— 1.2 What the game is not	0.5 p
2. Design pillars	heading
■ The Seven Pillars: What It Is and Isn’t	1 p
— 2.1 Attachment-first base-building	0.5 p
— 2.2 Named citizens, low population, durable identity	0.5 p
— 2.3 Ledger and legible	0.5 p
— 2.4 Expeditions make stories and enable progress	0.5 p
— 2.5 Consequence without disposability	0.5 p
— 2.6 Mechanical restraint, expressive variety	0.5 p
— 2.7 One world, four registers	0.5 p
● The world primer	0.5 p
■ The Cross-Section	1 p
● 3. Four registers	1.5 p
■ The Four Registers	1 p
— 3.1 Colony — dwell	0.5 p
— 3.2 Field — travel	0.5 p
— 3.3 Encounter — meet	0.5 p
— 3.4 Crossing — risk	0.5 p

— 3.5 Constraints binding all four	0.5 p
● 4. Three species	0.5 p
■ The Three Core Species	1 p
■ The Median Read Three Ways	1 p
— 4.1 Rabbit — burrow civilization	1 p
— 4.2 Squirrel — canopy civilization	0.5 p
◆ The Squirrel Cache Network	1 p
— 4.3 Wood Mouse — dense, distributed civilization	1 p
◆ The Wood Mouse Relay	1 p
— 4.4 The shared stat frame	1.5 p
— 4.5 Seasonal and environmental personalization	0.5 p
● 5. Two loops	0.5 p
■ The Two Loops	1 p
— 5.1 The domestic loop	0.5 p
— 5.2 The bridge between them	0.5 p
— 5.3 The expedition loop	1 p
● 6. One folklore	0.5 p
■ The Laws and Sayings of the Median	2 p
— 6.1 The Laws of the Median	2 p
■ PANEL 2 · THE TALE — “The morning Shadepatch was funny”	1 p
New Elderbank · Shadepatch, Bramble, Twig	
— 6.2 The Sayings of the Median	1.5 p
— 6.3 The Giants — vocabulary for the human world	1 p
■ The Giants: Vocabulary for the Human World	1 p

PART I — 36 PAGES

PART II — THE WORLD

The ground the game happens on, and the forces acting on it.

◆ Opener — The Corridor at Golden Hour

1 p

● Part standfirst

0.5 p

7. World geography and terminology

heading

— 7.1 The cross-section

0.5 p

— 7.2 Home Median

0.5 p

— 7.3 Highway

1 p

— 7.4 Margin

1 p

— 7.5 The median chain and the Median Reach

1 p

■ The Corridor Chain

1 p

— 7.6 What else is out there

0.5 p

8. Median biomes and Anchor Points

heading

— 8.1 The eight biomes

1 p

◆ MULTI-PAGE — The Eight Biomes, one establishing plate each

8 p

— 8.2 Anchor Points

0.5 p

■ Anchor Points

1 p

9. The day, traffic, and traffic as weather

heading

— 9.1 Daily structure

1 p

■ The Game Day

1 p

— 9.2 Traffic cycles

0.5 p

— 9.3 Traffic behaves like weather

1.5 p

■ Traffic as Weather

1 p

● 10. Choice-Event Cards

1 p

■ Choice-Event Cards

1 p

11. Seasons and Road Work

heading

— 11.1 Seasons

0.5 p

■ The Turn of the Seasons

1 p

◆ The Four Seasons at Home

2 p

— 11.2 Road Work

1.5 p

■ Road Work

1 p

◆ Road Work: Telegraph, Onset, Persistence

2 p

◆ “The season the machines came back”

0.5 p

■ PANEL 3 · THE CHRONICLE — “The fifth hole”

1 p

New Elderbank · Bramble, Teasel

PART II — 34 PAGES

PART III — THE COLONY

The home the whole game is in service of.

◆ Opener — The Rabbit Warren

1 p

● Part standfirst

0.5 p

● 12. Scale and the shape of a colony

0.5 p

■ The Colony

1 p

● 13. Roles and daily work

1.5 p

■ The Eight Roles

1 p

● 14. Resources and the economy

2 p

■ The Economy

1 p

◆ A Colony Built Into a Wreck

1 p

■ PANEL 4 · THE TALE — “Three days at the narrow place”

1 p

Rushbottom · Thimble, Pip, Husk

PART III — THE COLONY — CONTINUED

● 15. Construction, decay, and the Construction Queue	1.5 p
■ Construction and the Queue	1 p
◆ Worked example — one building, from need to completion	1 p
■ PANEL 5 · THE TALE — “The eleventh bridge”	1 p
Morningside · Cobb, Vane, Rowan	
16. Structures and upgrade ladders	heading
— 16.1 Structure families	2 p
■ Structures and Upgrade Ladders	2 p
— 16.2 Named upgrade ladders	1 p
— 16.3 Functional icons, the Community Board, and the Story Circle	1 p
■ The Community Board and the Story Circle	1 p

PART III — 22 PAGES

PART IV — THE CITIZENS

Who lives there, what happens to them, and how they are remembered. The heaviest part of the book, and correctly so.

◆ Opener — Bramble, Sharpnose and Daisy at the Story Circle	1 p
● Part standfirst	0.5 p
● 17. The citizen record	1 p
■ The Citizen Record	1 p
18. Bonds, Hearths, and growth	heading
— 18.1 Bonds	1 p
■ Bonds, Hearths and Nesting Season	1 p
■ PANEL 6 · THE TALE — “What Rowan and Cobb agreed on”	1 p
Morningside · Rowan, Cobb, Wick	
— 18.2 Hearths and lineage	1 p
— 18.3 Nesting Season	0.5 p
— 18.4 Wanderers — the other way a colony grows	1 p
■ Wanderers	1 p
■ PANEL 7 · THE TALE — “Nutmeg’s Crossing”	1 p
New Elderbank · Nutmeg, Bramble	
— 18.5 Death and memorialization	0.5 p
◆ The Memorial	1 p

19. Harm, fear, and tharn	heading
■ Harm, Fear and Tharn	1 p
— 19.1 The harm ladder	0.5 p
◆ A Maimed Veteran, Valued	1 p
◆ “Fennel, after the culvert”	0.5 p
■ PANEL 8 · THE TALE — “The route they chose for Teasel”	1 p
New Elderbank · Teasel, Daisy	
— 19.2 Fear and going tharn	2 p
◆ Going Tharn	1 p
◆ “Sharpnose goes tharn”	0.5 p
■ PANEL 9 · THE TALE — “Nobody is coming”	1 p
Rushbottom · Barley, Pip	
— 19.3 Distinctions, the symmetry, and the After-name	1 p
■ PANEL 10 · THE TALE — “Sharpnose at the fallen log”	1 p
New Elderbank · Sharpnose — THE MOCKUP, AS BUILT	
— 19.4 How citizens develop	0.5 p
● 20. Equipment: Keepsake, Tool, and Supply	2 p
■ Keepsake, Tool and Supply	1 p
● 21. Guest Citizens	0.5 p
— 21.1 Active Guests	3 p

PART IV — THE CITIZENS — CONTINUED

■ <i>Active Guests: The Seven</i>	2 p
◆ <i>Guest Vignettes — Raccoon, Mink, Crow, Fox, Weasel, Hedgehog, Snake</i>	2 p
— 21.2 Ambient Guests	2 p
■ <i>Ambient Guests: The Nine</i>	2 p
— 21.3 Antagonist fauna, and the ones who can change sides	1 p
● 22. The Records	1 p
■ <i>The Records</i>	1 p
— 22.1 The Colony Record — Almanac and Chronicle	0.5 p
■ PANEL 11 · THE CHRONICLE — “The Long Count”	1 p
■ <i>Rushbottom · Barley</i>	
— 22.2 The Citizen Record — Likeness and Tale	0.5 p
◆ <i>“Bramble’s Tale, illustrated”</i>	0.5 p
◆ <i>“A Legendary return”</i>	0.5 p
— 22.3 Expedition Rating and the Report and Share debrief	1 p
● 23. Names	0.5 p
■ <i>Names</i>	1 p
— 23.1 Names of citizens — Given Name and After-name	1 p
— 23.2 Names of places — the folk-name grammar	1 p
— 23.3 The one name the player authors	1 p

PART IV — 49.5 PAGES

PART V — LEAVING HOME

The three away-registers, and the systems that govern what happens out there.

◆ <i>Opener — The Night Crossing</i>	1 p
● Part standfirst	0.5 p
24. Crossing	heading
— 24.1 The crossing action	0.5 p
■ <i>The Crossing</i>	1 p
■ PANEL 12 · THE TALE — “Gale went first”	1 p
■ <i>Morningside · Gale</i>	
— 24.2 Return logic	0.5 p
25. Field Mode	heading
— 25.1 What it is	1 p
■ <i>Field Mode</i>	1 p
— 25.2 Presentation and overlays	0.5 p
◆ <i>Field Mode Traversal, and one node-reveal frame</i>	2 p
— 25.3 Node types	0.5 p
— 25.4 Field Mode generalizes	1 p
● 26. Encounters	0.5 p

— 26.1 The shape of an encounter	2 p
■ <i>The Encounter Frame</i>	1 p
— 26.2 Approaches	1.5 p
◆ <i>A Contested Encounter</i>	1 p
— 26.3 The group layer — mass, never a roster	0.5 p
— 26.4 Resolution	1.5 p
■ PANEL 13 · THE TALE — “Slip did not wait”	1 p
■ <i>Morningside · Slip, Gale, Vane</i>	
— 26.5 Exposure — the individual layer	1.5 p
■ <i>Exposure and Outcomes</i>	1 p
— 26.6 The outcome distribution	0.5 p
— 26.7 The epic case	0.5 p
— 26.8 Guardrails	0.5 p
— 26.9 What this system does not govern	0.5 p
27. Contest, recruitment, and Base Defense	heading
■ <i>Contest, Recruitment and Base Defense</i>	1 p
— 27.1 What is contested	0.5 p
— 27.2 The recruitment funnel	1 p
◆ <i>“The night WHOOT came in”</i>	0.5 p

PART V — LEAVING HOME — CONTINUED

■ PANEL 14 · THE CHRONICLE — “Churr, three times”	1 p
<i>Morningside · Churr, Rowan, Tassel</i>	
— 27.3 Slot scaling and scarcity	0.5 p
— 27.4 Base Defense	0.5 p
◆ <i>Base Defense</i>	1 p
28. Expeditions and the Launcher	heading
■ <i>Expeditions and the Launcher</i>	1 p
— 28.1 Expedition categories	1 p
— 28.2 The Expedition Launcher	1.5 p
◆ <i>Worked example — one expedition, end to end (précis; in full at Part IX)</i>	0.5 p
— 28.3 Early expedition onboarding	0.5 p
● 29. Outposts	0.5 p
■ <i>Outposts</i>	1 p
◆ <i>Establishing an Outpost</i>	1 p
— 29.1 Reach lifecycle and fog of war	0.5 p
— 29.2 The outpost building set	1 p
— 29.3 Stationing a citizen	0.5 p
— 29.4 Contest and the value of investment	0.5 p
◆ <i>“The first outpost, finished”</i>	0.5 p
— 29.5 Active versus passive value	0.5 p

PART V — 40.5 PAGES

PART VI — THE REST-STOP METROPOLIS

The corridor’s one city.

◆ <i>Opener — The Metropolis at Night</i>	1 p
● Part standfirst	0.5 p
30. The Metropolis	heading
— 30.1 The place	0.5 p
■ <i>The Rest-Stop Metropolis</i>	1 p
— 30.2 Presentation — a Field territory with venues as nodes	0.5 p
◆ <i>A Venue as a Node — the tavern interior, the raccoon bartender</i>	1 p
■ PANEL 15 · THE TALE — “What they say at the plaza”	1 p
<i>Rushbottom · Bran, Nook</i>	
— 30.3 Core functions	0.5 p
— 30.4 A founding myth, and what it does not mean	1 p
31. The Metropolis in the campaign	heading
— 31.1 Campaign role	0.5 p
— 31.2 Victory and continuation	0.5 p

PART VI — 8 PAGES · SEE THE FLAG ON PLATE 02

PART VII — PROGRESSION AND PRESENTATION

What the colony becomes, how it is drawn, and how a campaign opens.

◆ <i>Opener — The Founding Escape (the Ancestral Warren, seen intact, once)</i>	1 p
● Part standfirst	0.5 p
● 32. Progression tiers	0.5 p
■ <i>Progression Tiers</i>	2 p
— Tier I — Scavenger Camp	0.5 p
— Tier II — Fortified Settlement	0.5 p
— Tier III — Independent Colony	0.5 p
◆ <i>“The colony at Tier III”</i>	0.5 p
— Tier IV — Sovereign Network	0.5 p
— 32.1 Advancement gates	0.5 p
33. Interface and information design	heading

PART VII — PROGRESSION AND PRESENTATION — CONTINUED

■ <i>Interface and Information Design</i>	1 p
— 33.1 The Colony view	1 p
— 33.2 Blueprint / ledger overlay	0.5 p
— 33.3 Citizen Records and the Village Roster	0.5 p
— 33.4 The Expedition Launcher	0.5 p
— 33.5 Controls and accessibility	0.5 p
34. Art and sound	<i>heading</i>
— 34.1 Visual identity	0.5 p
— On anthropomorphism — the line	1.5 p
— 34.2 Scale language and vehicle presence	1 p
■ <i>Scale Language</i>	1 p
— 34.3 The sound of the world	0.5 p
■ <i>Art and Audio Style Guide</i>	1 p
35. Campaign onboarding	<i>heading</i>
— 35.1 The Founding Escape (cross-reference to front matter)	0.5 p
— 35.2 Tutorial sequence	1 p

PART VII — 18 PAGES

PART VIII — PRODUCTION NOTES

Suggestions, not canon. No plates, no opener — the one part that argues with itself.

● Part standfirst	0.5 p
36. Suggested scope and roadmap	<i>heading</i>
— 36.1 A suggested vertical slice	0.5 p
— 36.2 A suggested V1 target	1 p
— 36.3 A suggested approach to world events	0.5 p
— 36.4 Suggested later expansion candidates	0.5 p
● 37. Suggested prototype success criteria	1 p

PART VIII — 4 PAGES

PART IX — STORIES OF SURVIVAL

New in the book. Where the systems are seen operating rather than described, and where the book acquires an ending.

◆ <i>Opener — Return</i>	1 p
● Part standfirst	0.5 p
◆ <i>One Expedition, End to End — New Elderbank, the night the water rose</i>	6 p
◆ <i>A Colony at Three Ages — Rushbottom at Tier I, II and IV</i>	4 p
◆ <i>The Winter That Was Hard — Morningside, Road Work into the freeze</i>	4 p
◆ <i>Two Colonies, Two Philosophies — Morningside against Rushbottom</i>	3 p
◆ <i>The Grand Caravan</i>	1 p

PART IX — 19.5 PAGES

APPENDICES

A manifest in v0.4.6. Each is a separate authoring project.

● Appendix divider

● A — Building upgrade-name ladders

● B — Folk place-name component banks

● C — The hyphen-compounds

● D — The descriptive bands

● E — Played on a Screen

● F — Played at a Table

● G — Played with a Deck

● H — Pictured by the Machine

1 p

4 p

4 p

2 p

2 p

1 p

1 p

1 p

2 p

APPENDICES — 18 PAGES

BACK MATTER

The three colonies, indexed.

● The three story colonies — roster reference

● Index of named citizens, Guests and places

● Colophon

2 p

2 p

1 p

BACK MATTER — 5 PAGES

266.5 PAGES

The book, all in — front matter to colophon.

THE BASIS

Not guessed. Every text figure is derived from the actual word count of that section in v0.4.6, plus a surcharge for display matter — tables, pull-quotes, OPEN blocks and bulleted lists, which in this document are heavy and eat space a word count cannot see.

FORMAT
16:9 landscape, three-column text grid, no spreads (P2-39).

SET TEXT
300 words to a full page — a sourcebook density, allowing for leading, margins, headings, and the spot-illustration class running beside body text.

DISPLAY MATTER
One table row, blockquote line or bullet ≈ 1/28 of a page.

FLOOR
0.5 pages minimum for any section carrying text.

BARE HEADINGS
Numbered parents with no body text of their own — §7, §16, §18, §19 — carry no allocation and sit above their first child.

THE CHECK

24,140

WORDS OF BODY TEXT, ACROSS 133 SECTIONS

That yields 123.5 pages of set text — which lands almost exactly on the “140 pages of systems” already stated in Contents.md. It is the best available check that the density figure is right, and it was arrived at independently.

PLATE COSTS	
Infographic or full-page artwork	1 p
Doubles — the seven Active Guests, the nine Ambient Guests, four Tiers, three Road Work beats, four Seasons	2 p
The Eight Biomes, one plate per biome	8 p
Created visual — an inline sidebar, not a plate	0.5 p
Narrative panel — prose left, mechanic card right	1 p

Spot illustrations are not listed anywhere in these plates. They attach to body-text pages throughout and are already priced into the words-per-page figure.

WHAT THE FIGURES EXPOSED

Part IV is the heaviest part, and should be.

Six of the fifteen panels, five full-page artworks, ten infographics, and the two longest sections in the document. The book’s claim is that the player will know these animals by name; Part IV is where the claim is made.

Part VI does not yet earn its Part.

Eight pages, carrying less text than §21.1 Active Guests alone. Either the Metropolis earns more material — story_colonies.md already schedules a session for it — or it folds into Part V and the book has eight Parts.

Part VIII takes no opener and no plates.

It is explicitly not canon, and the canonical summary has moved forward to the front matter. Four pages, and it should stay austere.

Every figure here is a working estimate for planning, not a signature on a print order. Re-run it once the appendices are written; B and A alone will move the total.